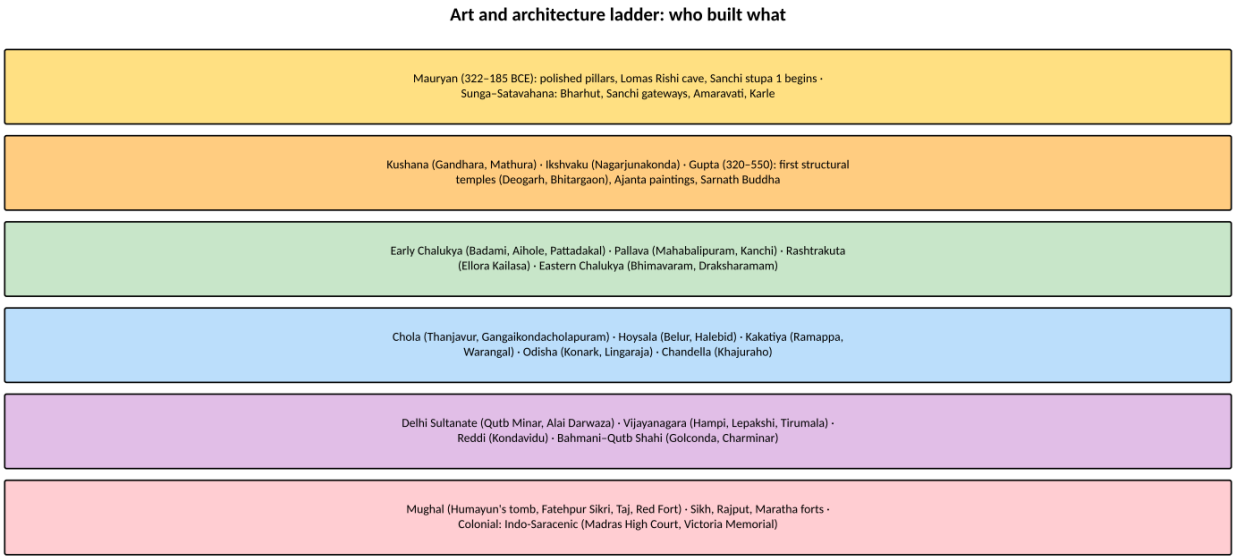
APPSC GROUP 1 / GROUP 2 — HISTORY

Volume 5: Art, Architecture and Culture — explained from the basics

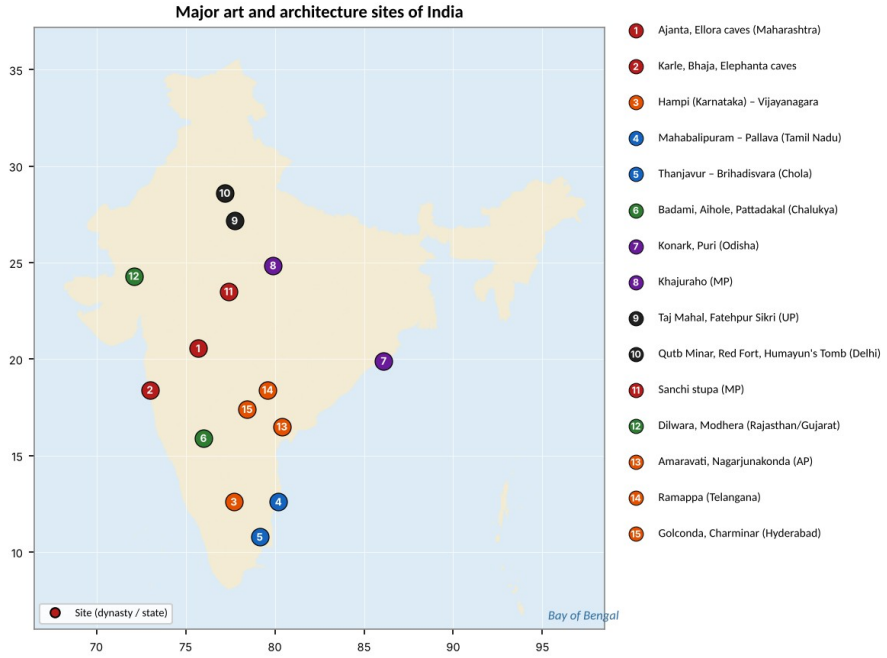
Early art · Buddhist and Jain art · Temple styles · Andhra and Telangana temples · Indo-Islamic and colonial buildings · Sculpture, painting, crafts · Music, dance, theatre and folk arts · Literature, languages, religion, festivals, heritage and institutions

How to use this volume:
1. Colours: **Blue** = simple explanation · **Orange** = Andhra Pradesh link (all regions) · **Red** = exam traps · **Green** = 2-minute revision · **Purple** = self-test.
2. Pictures here are drawn schematics and maps (stupa parts, temple styles, plans, pillar) made to teach the idea. Real photographs are best seen in NCERT and textbook plates; use the 'look-for' lines to recognise a monument.
3. Syllabus: Group 1 Prelims Paper I — History and Cultural Heritage of India and AP (art, architecture, literature, music, dance, religion, festivals); Mains Paper I Part A (Culture, Heritage); Group 2 History and Culture of AP. All eight areas have a chapter; chapter 9 is the self-test.
4. Andhra Pradesh and Telangana items are given equal space for every region: North Andhra, Coastal Andhra, Rayalaseema and Telangana.
5. Plan: 9 chapters in 9 days; revise green boxes on day 3 and day 10; then History Mock Test 5.

Art and architecture on one page



Map: major art and architecture sites of India



Syllabus map

Syllabus item	Chapter
Harappan art, Mauryan art, post-Mauryan schools, caves, stupas, Buddhist and Jain art	1, 2
Temple architecture (Nagara, Dravida, Vesara), dynastic styles, Andhra and Telangana temples (Satavahana to Vijayanagara)	3, 4
Indo-Islamic architecture, Deccan sultanates, Mughal, forts and palaces, colonial and modern buildings	5
Sculpture, painting (murals, miniatures, Kalamkari), crafts, textiles, GI products of AP and Telangana	6
Music (Hindustani, Carnatic, composers), classical and folk dances, theatre, puppetry, Kuchipudi, Perini	7
Languages, scripts, literature, religion and philosophy, festivals, UNESCO sites, institutions and awards	8

CHAPTER 1 — Early Indian Art: Harappa to the Satavahanas

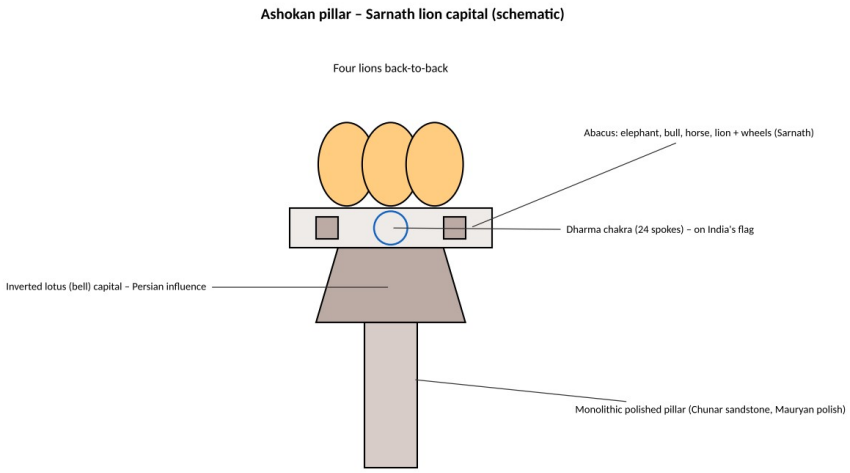
c. 2600 BCE – 300 CE

IN SIMPLE WORDS (what / how / why)

Art is a record of belief and power. Early Indians shaped clay, stone and metal for daily life first, then for religion, and then for kings. Reading the order of materials (clay → stone → polished stone → rock-cut caves → structural temples) gives you the whole story of Indian architecture.

Harappan (Indus) art: town planning (grid roads, drains, Great Bath at Mohenjo-daro, Dholavira reservoirs), seals with unicorn bull and Pashupati, bronze 'Dancing Girl' (lost-wax method), steatite 'Priest-king', terracotta mother goddess, beads of Lothal/Chanhudaro.

Mauryan art (322–185 BCE): court art and popular art



Type	Examples and key points
Court art: Ashokan pillars	Monolithic sandstone shaft (Chunar) with a mirror-like **Mauryan polish**; capitals: **Sarnath lion** (national emblem; 4 lions, wheel with 24 spokes, 4 animals), **Rampurva bull, Lauriya-Nandangarh lion, Sankisa elephant**. Persian bell-shaped capital influence.
Caves	**Barabar and Nagarjuni hills (Bihar)** – Ajivika caves donated by Ashoka and Dasharatha; polished interior; **Lomas Rishi cave** has a wooden-style horse-shoe door.
Popular art	**Yaksha–yakshi** figures (Didarganj Chauri-bearer, Parkham Yaksha), terracotta figurines, polished Mauryan sculpture; **Dhauli elephant** (Odisha) rock-cut.
Stupas	Ashoka rebuilt the **Sanchi Stupa 1 (brick core)**; earliest stupas at Piprahwa; Ashoka's **84,000 stupas** (tradition).

Post-Mauryan art (Sunga, Satavahana, Kushana, c. 200 BCE – 300 CE)

School / site	Features
Bharhut (MP, Sunga)	Railings and gateway with **Jataka scenes**; Buddha shown by **symbols** (wheel, footprints, bodhi tree, empty throne) = **aniconic** phase.
Sanchi (MP)	Great Stupa 1 with four carved **toranas** (gateways, Satavahana donors; **Satakarni's** inscription); **Shalabhanjika** (tree-nymph) brackets.
Gandhara (NW, Kushana)	**Greco-Roman** style: wavy hair, drapery, Buddha as human (**first Buddha images**); grey schist, stucco; Taxila, Peshawar; Kanishka.
Mathura (UP, Kushana)	**Indigenous** style: red sandstone, round face, smile, **Buddha, Vishnu, Shiva, Jain tirthankaras**; headless Kanishka statue; **Kankali Tila** Jain stupa.
Amaravati (Andhra, Satavahana–Ikshvaku)	**White marble (Palnadu limestone)** panels; flowing, **narrative** Jataka stories; Buddha by symbols in early phase, then human form; **Mahachaitya** (largest stupa in the south), now at Chennai, London (British Museum) and Amaravati museum.

ANDHRA PRADESH LINK

Andhra links by region: Coastal Andhra – Amaravati (Guntur), Ghantasala, Bhattiprolu, Chandavaram · **North Andhra** – Salihundam, Thotlakonda, Bavikonda · **Telangana** – Kotilingala, Phanigiri, Kondapur · **Rayalaseema** – Ashokan edicts at Yerragudi. The Satavahana kings built the **Sanchi toranas** and the Amaravati Mahachaitya, so Andhra is a core place in early Buddhist art.

EXAM TRAPS

Aniconic = Buddha shown by symbols (Bharhut, Sanchi, early Amaravati). Gandhara = Greek; Mathura = indigenous. Gandhara = grey schist; Mathura = red sandstone; Amaravati = white limestone.
Sarnath capital is Mauryan; the lion on the emblem shows 3 lions (4th hidden). Rampurva = bull; Sankisa = elephant.

2-MINUTE REVISION

Harappa: Great Bath, Dancing Girl (bronze, lost-wax) → Mauryan polish, Ashokan pillars, Sarnath → Bharhut–Sanchi (aniconic) → Gandhara (Greek) vs Mathura (Indian) vs Amaravati (narrative, marble).

CHAPTER 2 — Buddhist and Jain Art: Stupas, Caves, Chaityas

c. 300 BCE – 700 CE

IN SIMPLE WORDS (what / how / why)

Stupa = a mound that holds the Buddha's relics. The pilgrim walks clockwise (pradakshina) around it. **Chaitya** = prayer hall (with a stupa at the back). **Vihara** = monks' residence. Early caves copy wooden buildings in stone — you can see wood-style ribs,